

Global launch activity, 2002 to 2026

3,000 completed launches from Launch Library 2, pulled 19 September 2026

3,000 completed launches	94.6% of launches succeeded	341 launches in 2025	24% flown by SpaceX
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Summary

Launches grew from about 55 a year in 2004 to about 100 by 2014 and held near that level through 2017. The count passed 120 in 2018, and 2025 reached 341, more than three times the 2017 total. More than half of the 3,000 launches in this dataset, 1,556 of them, happened since 2020.

Reliability held steady while volume grew. About 94% of launches succeeded in the 2000s and 2010s, and about 95% in the 2020s. SpaceX flew about 24% of all launches, and Falcon 9 flew 689 times with 4 failures.

These numbers cover the 3,000 most recent launches in the database, from part of 2002 to 19 September 2026. They are not the full history, and the first and last years are partial.

Launch volume

Launches rose from about 55 in 2004 to about 100 in 2014 and stayed between 90 and 100 through 2017. The count jumped to about 124 in 2018 and has risen every year since 2021, from about 160 to 341 in 2025.

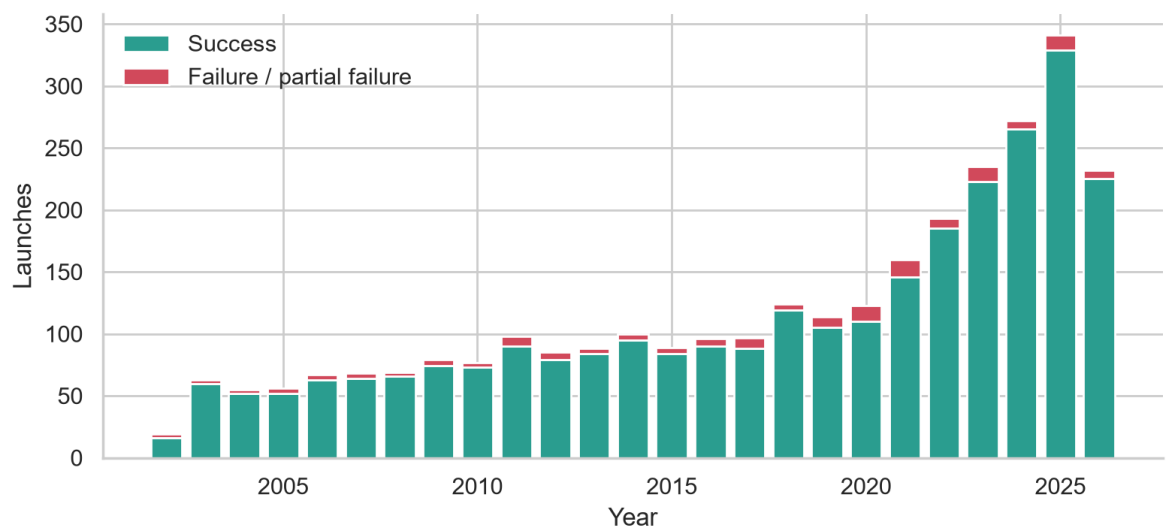


Figure 1. Completed launches per year, split by outcome. 2002 starts partway through the year; 2026 runs to 19 September.

2026 stands at about 230 launches as of 19 September. Extended over a full year at that rate, the total would land near 320, a little below 2025. The 2002 bar is short because the dataset starts partway through that year.

Reliability

94.6% of the 3,000 launches succeeded, which leaves about 160 failures and partial failures. Success rates stayed close across decades: about 94% in the 2000s, about 94% in the 2010s and about 95% in the 2020s. The 2020s hold 1,556 launches, more than the 2010s (968), and the failure rate did not rise.

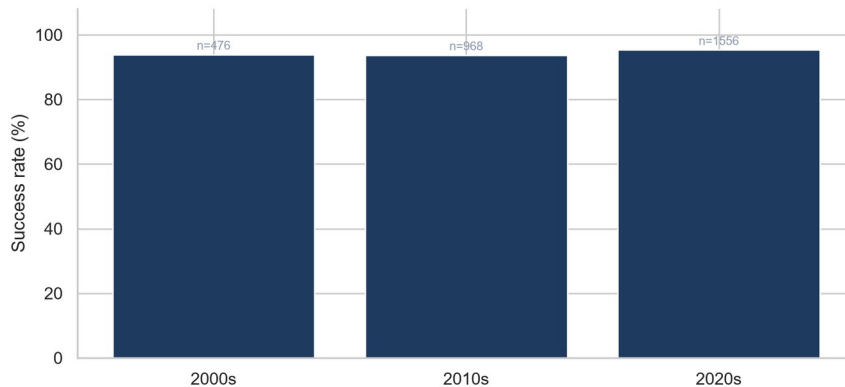


Figure 2. Success rate by decade (n = launches in that decade). The 2000s start in 2002 and the 2020s run to 19 September 2026.

Falcon 9 flew 689 times, 23% of all launches in the data, and 685 of those launches succeeded. Delta II (52 launches) and Atlas V 401 have no failures. Long March 2D failed once in 98 launches.

A few rockets sit below the rest. The two Proton-M entries show 11 failures in 115 launches together, a success rate of 90.4%. Rokot/Briz-KM has the lowest rate among rockets with 20 or more launches, at 89.3%. SpaceShipTwo, a suborbital vehicle, has 5 failures in 67 launches. Electron has 4 in 96.

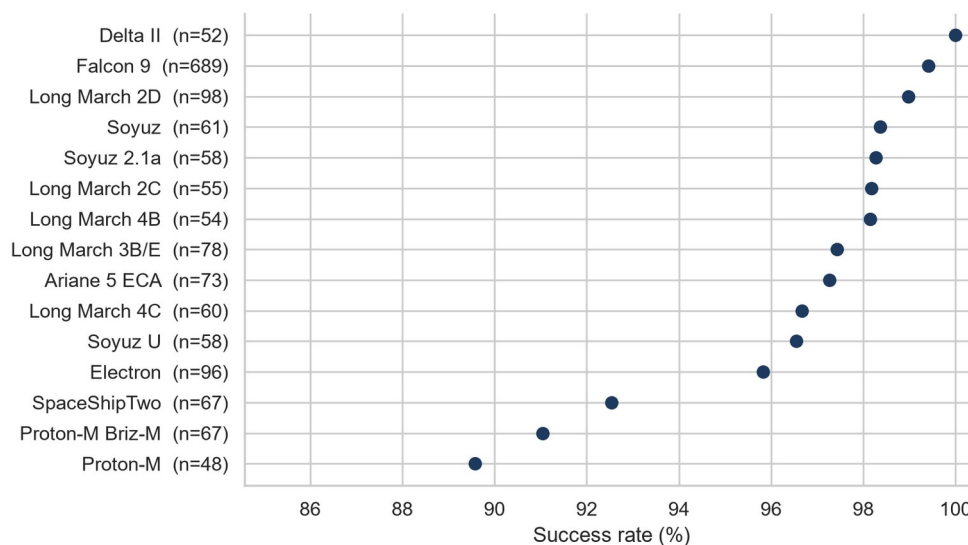


Figure 3. Success rate of the 15 most-launched rockets. The axis starts near 84%, so small gaps look larger than they are.

Table 1. The 15 most-launched rockets in the window, sorted by launches.

Rocket	Launches	Failures	Success rate
Falcon 9	689	4	99.4%
Long March 2D	98	1	99.0%
Electron	96	4	95.8%
Long March 3B/E	78	2	97.4%
Ariane 5 ECA	73	2	97.3%
SpaceShipTwo	67	5	92.5%
Proton-M Briz-M	67	6	91.0%
Soyuz	61	1	98.4%
Long March 4C	60	2	96.7%
Soyuz 2.1a	58	1	98.3%
Soyuz U	58	2	96.6%
Long March 2C	55	1	98.2%
Long March 4B	54	1	98.1%
Delta II	52	0	100.0%
Proton-M	48	5	89.6%

These 15 rockets account for 1,614 launches, 54% of the data, and 37 failures, a success rate of 97.7%. The other 1,386 launches succeeded about 91% of the time.

Selection effects explain some of the gap. Rockets with early failures tend to retire before they build a long record, so the table favors vehicles that already work. The second group also mixes retired rockets, debut vehicles and ones that fly a few times a year, and this analysis cannot separate them.

Providers and orbits

SpaceX led with about 725 launches, 24% of the total. A Chinese state-owned aerospace group came second with about 600, or 20%. Together they flew about 44% of the launches in the window.

Russian launches appear under three names in the source data: the Russian Federal Space Agency (about 220), the Khrunichev space center (about 100) and the Russian Space Forces (about 100). Merged, they total about 420 and would rank third. Arianespace and United Launch Alliance follow with about 175 launches each.

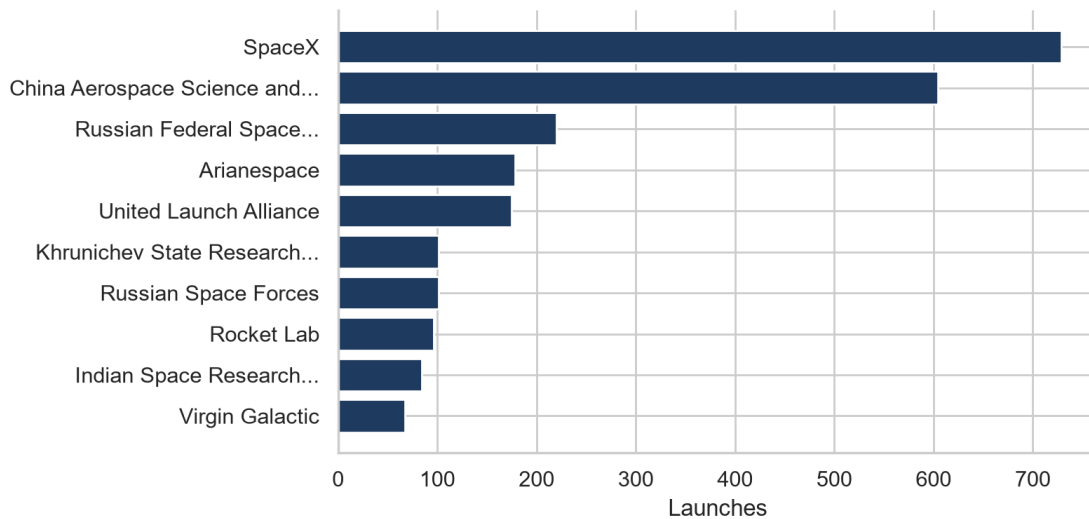


Figure 4. The ten providers with the most launches. Long names are cut off, and Russian launches are split across three bars.

Low Earth orbit (LEO) is the most common destination, at about 1,190 launches, or 40% of the total. Sun-synchronous orbit (SSO) follows with about 460 and geostationary transfer orbit (GTO) with about 365. About 160 launches, 5%, were suborbital.

The ten orbits in the chart cover about 2,590 launches. The other 410 or so have an unknown orbit or one outside the top ten. The data lists destinations, not payloads, so it cannot say what these launches carried.

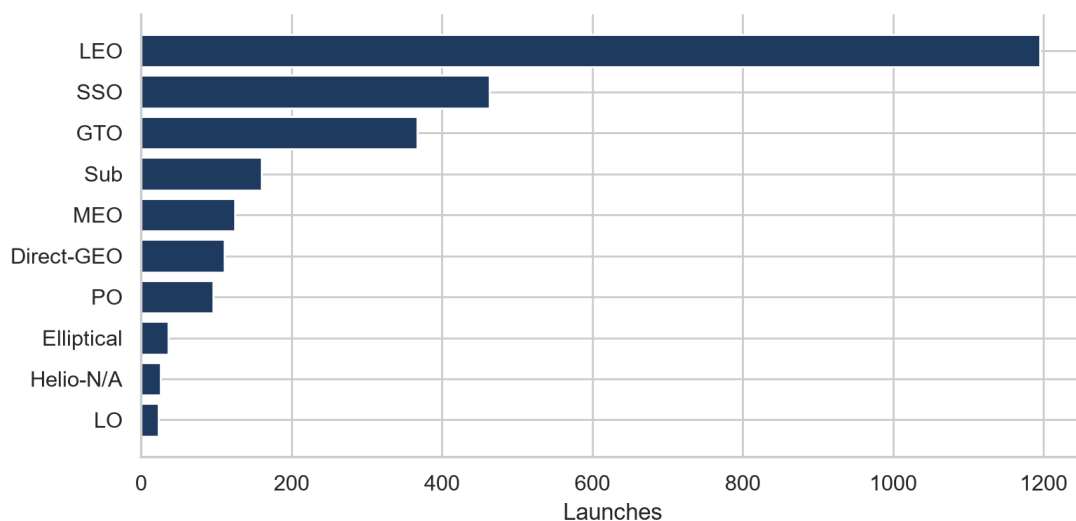


Figure 5. The ten most common target orbits. MEO is medium Earth orbit and Sub is suborbital. Launches with an unknown orbit are excluded.

About the data

I pulled the data from Launch Library 2, a community-maintained database run by The Space Devs (thespacedevs.com). It lists more than 7,600 past launches. The free API tier limits how many requests a user can make, and results arrive newest first, so this report covers the 3,000 most recent launches instead of the full archive.

A launch counts as a success when its status is Launch Successful. Every other outcome, including a partial failure, counts as a failure. The analysis excludes launches with no recorded outcome, such as scheduled ones. The database also includes suborbital flights, so the totals cover more than orbital launches. Rockets appear under the names the source uses, so one family can show up more than once. Soyuz, Soyuz 2.1a and Soyuz U are separate entries, and so are the two Proton-M entries.

Two edges of the window are partial. The 2002 figures cover the months the dataset reaches, and the 2026 figures stop at 19 September. Every rocket and provider figure describes this window and not the full history of that vehicle or company.